The external dimension has always played a pivotal role in fuelling and sustaining insurgencies in the North-east. With insurgencies having lost the ideological space and their combative potency reduced to marginal levels today, we are on the cusp of eliminating this menace from the North-east landscape. While significant ground needs to be covered internally in culminating the Naga Peace Process and restoring peace in Manipur, it is sad that the current turmoil in Myanmar and Manipur has again given space to IIGs. In the current milieu, while AR is focused on the IMB, close cooperation between the two sides continues to be the need of the hour. This, therefore, should continue to be the focus of our diplomatic endeavours with Myanmar.

It will be pertinent to mention that while the China–Myanmar Economic Corridor (CMEC) projects are progressing with marginal disruption, mainly due to the unique ability of the Chinese to run with the hare and hunt with the hound; our projects, viz. KMMTP and the India–Myanmar Thailand Trilateral (IMTT) Highway, are lagging. We need to find our own unique solutions in the maze of possibilities. Operation Sunrise is one successful example.

At Delhi, we shifted to the Vice-Chief's residence on Safdarjung Road. Gen Rawat, too, had been in the same house as the Vice-Chief and had taken over on the same day, 1 September, three years earlier in 2016. After a short stint of only four months, he had been promoted to Chief. Was the same fate in store for me?

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